

You said it...



Announcement: *Hi folks! We've been getting some requests from our readers to bundle x86-64 OS instead of the regular x86 OS that we bundle every month. The reason we have only been bundling 32-bit OSs is because we believe a 64-bit OS may not support the processors that many of our readers use. However, do consider this as an open call for votes on whether you, the readers, would prefer a 32-bit OS or a 64-bit OS. Please send us your feedback at [lfyedit at fyindia dot com](mailto:lfyedit@fyindia dot com) by July 20, 2009.*



I picked up a copy of *LFY* April 2009 after quite a few years (definitely more than 12 months and it was only because I wanted to grab the Debian 5 Lenny DVD for personal use), and I must say I was delighted to see the magazine has improved by leaps and bounds. The last time I read *LFY*, I saw definite potential in what seemed to be a budding magazine trying to create a niche for itself in the Linux/Open Source world. Now, you guys pretty much seem to be at the top and you definitely rock.

I can't seem to recollect the last time a magazine that I picked up took me over two days to read and complete (and believe me—I practically read every article and every contribution in there). The entire content kept me captivated and thrilled. I would like to consider myself a geek who experiments with technology just to be aware of the developments around the world. My day-time job is that of a banker, wherein I rarely, if ever, deal with anything remotely technical in nature.

If time does permit, I would seriously consider a long-term subscription with your magazine—with the superb quality of content

that you guys now put out. I just wanted to let you guys know that please continue doing the excellent work—it's been a pleasure to see that quality magazines still do get published.

—**Somani Kisalay, kisalay.somani@citi.com**

ED: *Thanks for your encouraging feedback. We hope you'll continue to send us feedback on the content of the magazine—things you like, you dislike, and what you think is missing...*



The editorial of the May 2009 issue left me a bit worried. Sun's acquisition by Oracle is indeed big news, and that is part of the cause for concern. While companies developing open source software are definitely helping the 'ecosystem' because of their powerful support, I believe we should not lose sight of the main idea behind free software. Free software was nothing new at the time [Richard] Stallman started the movement, but the movement was required because companies were commercialising software, threatening the programming culture and its free sharing of source code. The members and supporters of the free software community have always been mostly people who care deeply about the joy of programming and defending their freedom.

Today, when free software has reached such heights, it is essential for the community to ensure that commercial companies do not topple it over. And for that, the foundation needs to be strong. Licences like the GPL do protect against the 'locking up' of software, but we need to ensure that the software we create gets this protection by actually using

such licences. It would be a pity and a shame if commercialisation gets the better of the free software movement.

—**Saurav Sengupta, Chandigarh**



I have been a subscriber of *LFY* right from its first issue and have tried various flavours of Linux, thanks to your magazine. Right after installation, I always first try the card games (to see whether there is any improvement) and multimedia support.

I always felt that PCLinuxOS is the best for newcomers and the one in the current issue is even better. Windows partitions are mounted automatically, network cards are installed without a problem and, unlike other distros, multimedia support is comprehensive. FLV videos in Windows partitions are played without any need for other codecs (although the lip sync feature was missing). I wonder why VLC player is not included. Also, the UI of the card game has improved tremendously. Of course, LAN modems are not supported and I gather that it is a pain to install drivers for them.

On an entirely different track, I shall be happy to get some feedback about the *bsnl.in* portal. Recently, I applied for a second BSNL connection. The instrument was delivered the next day and the number allotted within a day after that. However, they took more than a week to allot the broadband password. On connecting, I faced a peculiar problem—a few sites such as BSNL's own *DataOne.in* as well as *ICICIBank.com* fail to open. (ICICI sites open at times after a long delay.) Gmail also has some problem. I suppose that the BSNL portal must be a new one, and any help from the readers on how to get around the problems